Pictures and little messages

Choose the pictures or message for today. Print only the pages you need, single-sided on A4 at 100%. An adult cuts the cards. Print another copy if you need extra cards.

What is in this pack

Page 2 — six pictures
Pan, cup, sun, sock, pen and pin. The picture cards have no words on their cut faces.

Page 3 — two pictures
A woven mat and a folded map. Choose one meaning and word at a time.

Page 4 — Sam sat.
One whole model strip and one cut-up set: Sam | sat | full stop.

Page 5 — Sam can sit.
One whole model strip and one cut-up set: Sam | can | sit | full stop. This later message is optional.

Prepare with the reading cards

• For the story bag, use the adult-read pan and cup labels in English Opening Reading Cards, page 5. The teacher reads them; the child need not decode them.

• For letter matching, reuse the two s cards on page 2 of English Opening Reading Cards or English Reading & Word-Building Cards, whichever is in use. For a sun label, write sun on a plain card and read it aloud.

• For mat or map, reuse their word cards on page 8 of English Reading & Word-Building Cards. Reuse the needed loose letters from pages 2 and 7. Introduce their sounds and meanings first.

• For pan and pin, use the printed word cards in English Reading & Word-Building Cards, pages 5–6. Put answer pictures aside for a print-first reading turn.

A few helpful boundaries

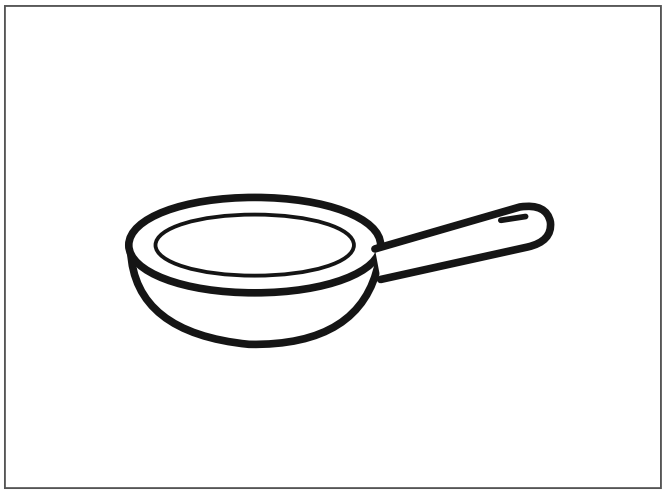
• Use only a picture of a pin, never a real sharp pin. Keep pan and cup as pictures, not hot, heavy or breakable objects.

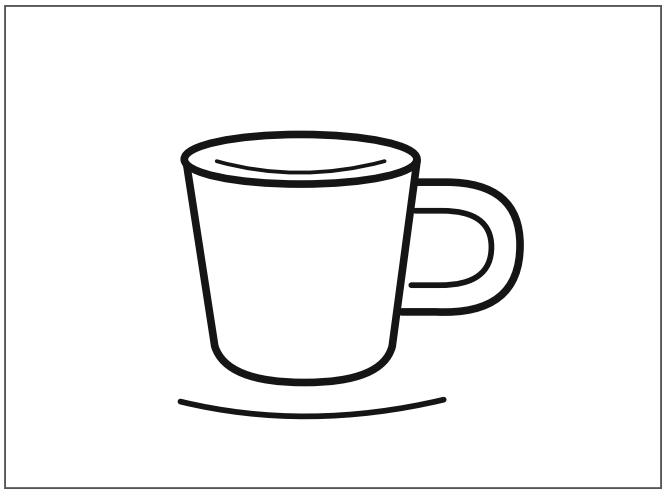
• The picture names in a listening game are not automatically words for independent reading. Pretend Sam is not a real child. In the later message, can means “is able to”, not a tin can.

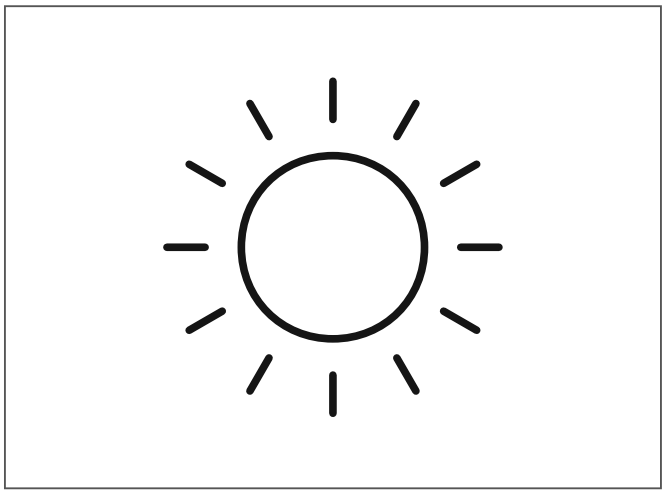
• Writing is optional. Use How to write English letters when a child chooses to copy a letter; these cut cards are not formation models.

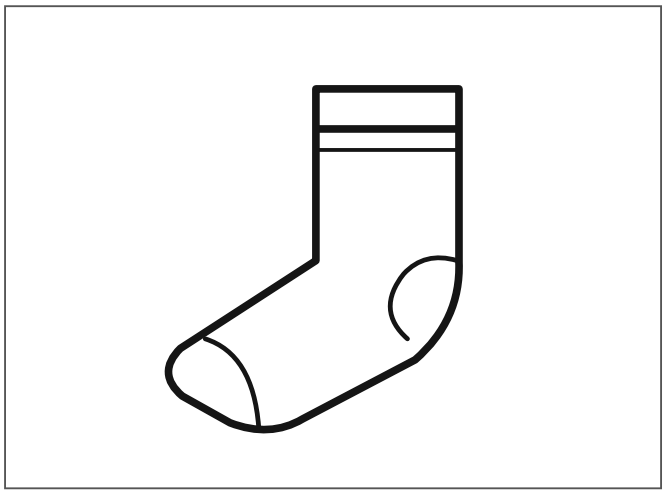
Pictures for our games

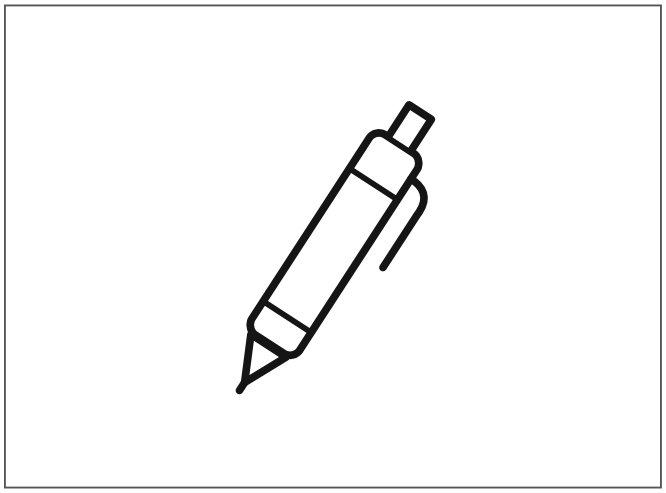
Cut out each picture. Keep words on separate cards.

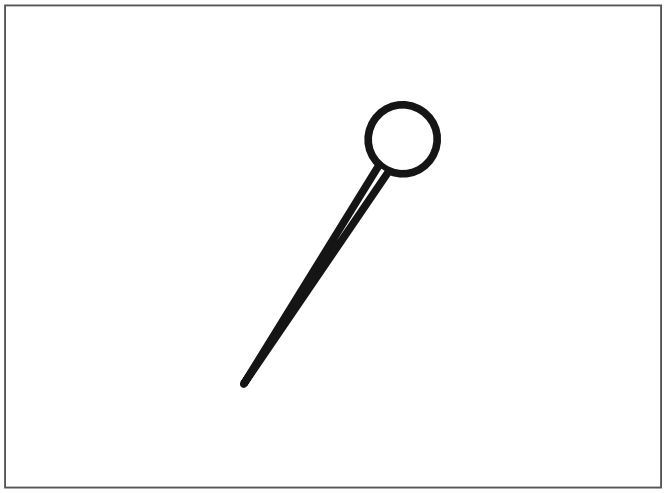












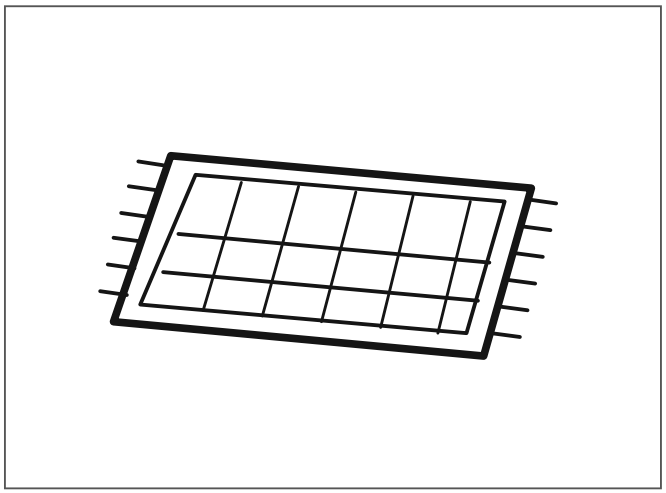
Teacher key before cutting: top row pan / cup; middle row sun / sock; bottom row pen / pin. The pin picture shows a straight, round-headed pin; the pen has a barrel, clip and writing tip.

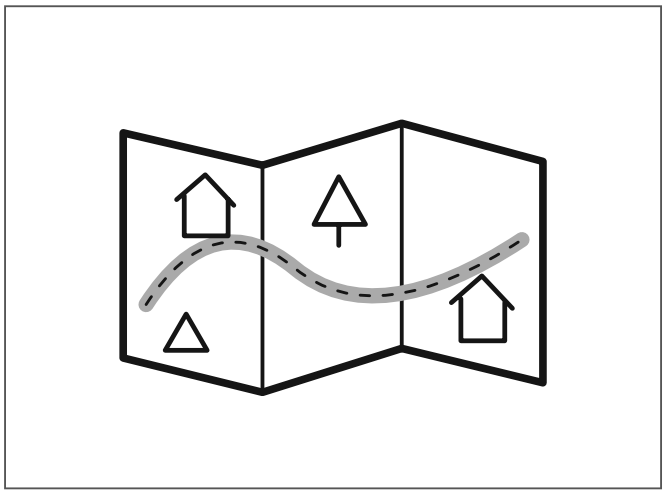
Use the picture of the pin only. Names in a listening game are not automatically words for independent reading.

A word for my picture

For the little message book: mat or map, one word at a time.

Use after m, short a, t and p have been introduced as needed, and both meanings are familiar. This is the existing later word route, not an opening-set reading expectation.





Use the mat/map word cards on page 8 of English Reading & Word-Building Cards. Reuse the loose letters from pages 2 and 7; no second printed set is needed here.

Talk about one chosen picture, then put it aside before a print-first reading turn. Do not guess map from the picture of a mat.

A little message: Sam sat.

Optional extension / choose this route only when its prerequisites are familiar.

Introduce s, short a, m and t, capital S, the pretend name Sam, and the meaning of sat. Show spaces and the full stop. This tells about something that happened; it is not an instruction to sit.

Sam sat.

Print another copy of this page if more cards are needed.

Keep one whole strip as a model. Cut the cards below; the full-stop card is intentionally large.

Sam	sat	.

Give the message a meaning

Draw pretend Sam sitting or act out what happened. Read the message together. Invite arranging, drawing or writing with suitable support. Do not introduce the next sentence just to finish the page.

Use a pretend character, not a real child's identity. Copying, remembering a picture and independently reading are different. Handwriting is optional.

A little message: Sam can sit.

Optional later extension / keep separate from the first sentence.

Use after s, short a, m, c as /k/, n, short i and t are taught, with capital S familiar. Explain can as “is able to”. Reading Sam sat. does not prove that this new message is understood.

Sam can sit.

Print another copy of this page if more cards are needed.

Arrange the words in order. Leave spaces and place the full stop at the end.

Sam	can	sit	.

Draw or act out the meaning with pretend Sam. Use cards, drawing or adult writing as comfortable. Do not replace the word can with a tin-can picture: that would teach a different meaning.